

Haveli Mai Jindan (Maharani Jindan Haveli)

حویلی مائی جندان

1. Basic Facts

- Built by: Origin uncertain; believed by some to be an underlying Mughal-era structure, extensively modified and expanded during the Sikh period
- Built in: Original date uncertain; Sikh-period modifications attributed variously to Chand Kaur or Rani Jind Kaur ("Mai Jindan")
- Cost: Not documented
- Built for: A residence associated with Rani Jind Kaur, mother of the last Sikh Maharaja, Duleep Singh

2. Construction Details

- Materials/technique: Not documented in available sources

3. Historical Background

- Duleep Singh, the last Sikh Maharaja of Punjab, was born here in 1838.
- The building later housed the collection of Princess Bamba (Duleep Singh's daughter), including paintings and artefacts, and today is associated with Sikh heritage displays.

4. Interesting Facts / Trivia

- This haveli is one of the few structures in the fort with a direct, documented connection to the birth of a ruler - Duleep Singh's birth here in 1838 ties the building to the very end of the independent Sikh Empire, just over a decade before British annexation.

5. Scenario / Narrative Moment

In 1838, inside this haveli, a child is born who will grow up to be the last Maharaja of an independent Sikh empire - and who will, within his own lifetime, watch that empire's capital, and this very fort, pass into British hands.